

Housing Recovery & Reconstruction Platform (HRRP)
Chandragiri Municipality Meeting Minute
Kathmandu, Nepal

Date: 12th February, 2016

Time: 11:00 AM

Venue: Chandragiri Municipality

Chaired By: Govinda Prasad Pandey, Executive Officer

HRRP District Coordinator: Ruji Rajbhandari

HRRP IM Focal Point: Samrachhika Manandhar

Attendees:

Govinda Prasad Pandey, Deepak Upadhy (Chandragiri Municipality), Yatra Sharma (Lumanti), Laxmi Prasad Shrestha (NEPAN), Priti Maharjan (Oxfam/Lumanti), Smriti Bajracharya (Oxfam/Lumanti), Binita Shrestha, Devendra, Ratna Kumari, Chandika Shrestha (Bishnu Devi Mahila Sakos), Nirmala Shrestha, Puna Maya Maharjan (Thankot Mahila Jagaran Sakos), Rachana Kunwar (HRRP), Ajit Thakali (HRRP), Sailesh Acharya (HRRP), Binita Shrestha (HRRP)

Agenda:

1. Welcome
2. Introduction
3. HRRP : Overview
4. Keynote Speech: Chandragiri Municipality Executive Officer
5. Updates of Housing Recovery & Reconstruction Activities by Partner Organizations
6. Open Discussion
 1. Gap Identification
 2. Concerns / limitations for Recovery and Reconstruction implementation
7. Tentative date for next meeting

Summary of the meeting:

HRRP district coordinator and information management assistant organized municipal level meeting at Chandragiri municipality and welcomed 17 participants who are involved in reconstruction project with the municipality. Govinda Prasad Pandey, Executive Officer along with Deepak Upadhy, Social Development Officer presented organizations working or planning to work in their municipality in the recovery and reconstruction sector. Moreover, he even highlighted the main issues to focus during the phase of reconstruction. Other participants involved partner organizations, representing overview of their working model and resources. Similarly, local woman cooperative representatives highlighted their issues currently arising in the community.

Introduction

The Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform, District Coordinator, Ruji Rajbhandari presented about working structure, objectives, role and responsibilities of HRRP. She requested partner organizations and the municipality representatives to update their activities in recovery and reconstruction projects.

Updates

- **Mr. Govinda Prasad Pandey** updated about the organizations involved during emergency relief and other interested organizations
- **Mr. Deepak Upadhya** acknowledged that 600 houses were damaged and reconstruction and repairs were made by the local people
- **Ms. Yatra Sharma** from Lumanti shared they are planning to provide technical support to rebuild 150 houses and repair 100 houses in Machhengaun. She also presented the problems faced during the reconstruction program.
- **Ms Smriti Bajracharya**, Oxfam has conducted wash program in Chandragiri and planning to support with 60-150 toilets

Agency Updates

Lumanti Support Group For Shelter :

- Currently at design and planning phase for reconstruction and wash sector in Chandragiri municipality
- Lumanti has planned and designed the reconstruction of entire area giving special preference to heritage and tourism conservation. Projects area in Maccheegaun is in Taukhel Ward no 13, where maximum historical houses had been damaged by the earthquake. Lumanti has planned to give 150 technical assistance for reconstruction.
- Main issues in Maccheegaun :
 - Many people did not have land ownership/ documents
 - Same building by-laws for core and outskirts creating confusion for issues like setback in core areas. For example minimum width of the road should be 10 feet, but existing roads in core areas are very narrow resulting in un-habitable spaces.
 - People were uncertain about the process of grant distribution whether the grant would be distributed by the government or the POs, or both agencies.
 - Local residents were concerned about the uncertain grant distribution timeline.

NEPAN :

- 250 temporary shelters constructed
- Rs. 7,500 relief supported to elderly people affected by earthquake
- Still in planning phase for reconstruction and recovery

Oxfam :

- On-going short term mason training for EQ resistant construction at Bisankhu Narayan (Daxhinkali Municipality)
- Future planned project is vocational training at Nagarjun municipality
- During emergency phase had worked in 12 wards of Chandragiri Municipality for WASH projects
- Conducted hygiene promotion programs in earthquake affected areas
- Rs 5000 worth of support was provided for Pipeline, water tanks and other wash related needs
- 150 toilets supported as emergency relief construction

Key Discussion

- Projects should be planned and implemented in coordination with Municipality.
- Issues in the community arising on land ownership/ documents for further reconstruction of damaged buildings.
- Need for new or revised building by-laws for core and traditional areas.
- Government's policy on eligibility criteria and grant distribution process.
- Public has started re-building houses instead of waiting for new policy.
- Status and timeline of upcoming projects
- Status of technical Training: Mason/Carpentry/ Building Code implementation/Counselling
- Good overall coordination between partner agencies and government needed.
 - Proposed re-construction projects should be result oriented
 - Technical support for revision of building by-laws in core areas should be initiated
- Need for Social/Community Awareness on how to "build back safer"

Next Meeting

To be discussed.

AOB